

Venetian School

In the late 15th century, Giovanni Bellini (c.1430–1516) began a strong tradition of painting in Venice, with lucid and brilliantly coloured altarpieces and small devotional works. Influenced by his brother-in-law Mantegna, in turn Bellini inspired his pupils, particularly Giorgione (c.1477/8–1510) and Titian. Thanks to the vivid pigments available in Venice, colour predominated Venetian paintings. Almost nothing is known of Giorgione's short life, and only six or seven paintings can be definitively attributed to him, but he worked with Titian on several projects, and his small paintings are mysterious and dreamlike.

Working in Venice for a large part of his career, Sebastiano del Piombo (1485–1587) captured the harmonious qualities of Bellini and Giorgione, and the rich colours of Veronese and Titian. Paolo Caliari, known as Paolo Veronese (1528–88), was born in Verona but lived in Venice for most of his life. Famous for large narrative paintings, he is categorized with Titian and Tintoretto as one of the 'great trio' of Venetian High Renaissance artists.



Veronese, *Conversion of Mary Magdalene*, c.1548